

*Out of Piccolo, back into the carnival, the cook's ladle still bright in your mind.
Whatever else he is, he has chosen to trust you this far — and to ask something of you in return.*

INFILTRATE THE CASTLE

Messengers — you asked to be trusted. Here is how you earn it.

Before this night is over, we move against the Order, but we move half-blind. The Komtur of the castle, Albrecht, knows more about us than we would like. We need to know what he knows — and how much.

He is a proud man. He walks outside the castle walls as if the city were already his, certain no one would dare touch him. (*Do not go into the ruins themselves — they are watched, and barred to the likes of you. Find him in the open, before the walls.*)

YOUR TASK: get close to him. Talk to him. But do it as someone he wants to talk to.

WEAR ANOTHER FACE — the carnival lends you one for free. Half the city is masked tonight; one more set of strangers eager to talk means nothing. You are not couriers, and you are NEVER, EVER OF THE COUNCIL — say that and you are dead. You are townsfolk who smell which way the wind blows: little people, eager to please the Order, who have *heard things* about those plotting against it. He feeds on that. Offer him a whiff of a name, a rumour, a hint that you know who schemes — and let him talk. Draw him out. See what he lets slip.

Flatter him. Let him boast. A proud man with something to hide always shows more than he means to.

Get from him what you can — a name he lets fall, a plan he has caught wind of, how much the Order has already guessed. When you have it, slip back into the crowd. Do not linger. Do not be a face he remembers.

Burn nothing. Trust no one in a Teutonic mantle. — J.

Scouts, then. You can be scouts. Find the proud Komtur, smile, lie a little, and listen. A man that sure of himself never hides things well.